Chalk maple (also whitebark maple, whitebarked maple, pale-bark maple)

Acer leucoderme

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Beltline: 2 **TOTAL 2**



Summer / form
Library candidate



Fall color
Library candidate

Not available

Flower
Not available



Leaf close-up
Library candidate

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Not stated
Mature size: 25–30 ft (often multi-trunked; to 8–9 m or up to 15 m / 23 m in some accounts) × 25 ft with rounded crown
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Hardy in USDA zones 5a–9b, including 8a and 8b. Native to the southeastern United States including Georgia Piedmont. Heat and drought tolerant once established. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a conditions.
Sun: Full sun to deep shade / partial shade
Water: Moist, well-drained; tolerates occasionally dry and dry soils once established. High drought tolerance.
Soil: Good drainage, moist, rocky, slightly acidic to neutral; adapts to poor shallow soils, clay, sand, loam.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: (Care / planting pass — re-run 2026-10-12): Plant at grade in full sun to partial shade in moist, well-drained soil. Prune to a single trunk if desired for structure. High drought tolerance once established. First-year irrigation: Not stated in qualified extension sources (nursery note of weekly through first two summers is secondary). Mulch depth, spacing, mound vs level, and soil amendment: Not stated. [NC State Extension Gardener Plant Toolbox; UF/IFAS ENH-178]
Soil prep: Good drainage, moist, rocky, slightly acidic to neutral; adapts to poor shallow soils, clay, sand, loam.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Native to the southeastern United States (North Carolina to Florida, west to eastern Texas and Oklahoma). First recognized as a distinct species by John Kunkel Small in 1895 from observations along the Yadkin River, North Carolina and the Yellow River, Georgia. Understory tree of rocky slopes, bluffs, and stream banks. [Trees and Shrubs Online; POWO; Flora of North America]
Form / habit: Multi-stemmed, oval to rounded crown; often multi-trunked understory tree; can be pruned to single trunk
Foliage: Bright yellow to scarlet / yellow-orange to cardinal crimson / yellow, orange, deep red
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Pale gray to chalky white (especially upper trunk of mature trees); becomes ridged and blackish at base with age. Name “leucoderme” means white skin.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: (Health / infestation pass — re-run 2026-10-12): None known as serious problems. Pest free / free of serious pests and diseases. No significant disease or pest issues stated. Verticillium wilt susceptibility noted as susceptible in one source. Common maple insects and diseases (scale, leaf spot, anthracnose) may occur but are not reported as serious for this species. [NC State Extension Gardener Plant Toolbox; UF/IFAS ENH-178; South Carolina Native Plant Society]